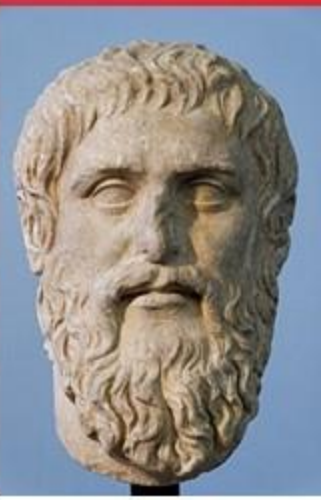
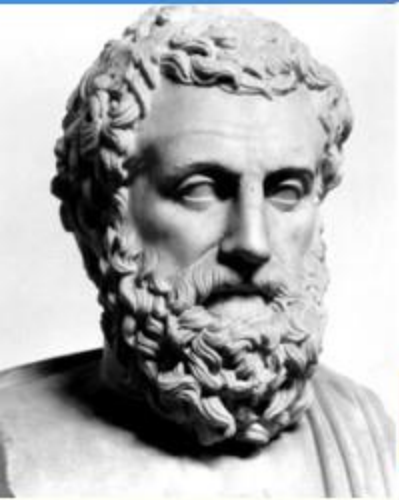


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



MODULE - 6

**ETHICAL DECISION
MAKING**

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

ETHICAL DECISION MAKING PROCESS



1 RECOGNISE THE ISSUE

- ✓ Does this decision involve a **choice between a good and bad** alternative, or perhaps between two "goods" or between two "bads"?
- ✓ Could the decision **be damaging** for any of the stakeholders (someone or some group)?
- ✓ Is this issue about **more than what is legal** or what is most **efficient**? If so, how?

There may be multiple ethical issues – focus on one major one at a time.

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

ETHICAL DECISION MAKING PROCESS



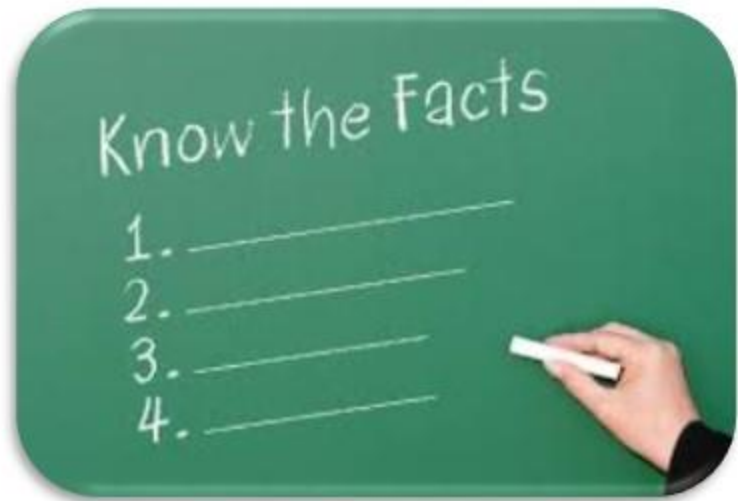
1 RECOGNISE THE ISSUE

- ✓ If I do not act on what I noticed, it may exacerbate the situation of Gargi.
- ✓ To ignore the issue will make me feel morally responsible for the continuation of her plight.
- ✓ If my suspicion of sexual abuse turns out true, it is a legal issue too.
- ✓ If I act on my suspicion and if it turns out wrong, it will cause huge damage to the reputation of her step father.
- ✓ If I confront Gargi to come out with truth, it may force her further into a shell.

Focus on one ethical issue at a time.

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

ETHICAL DECISION MAKING PROCESS



Questions to ask: **Who, what, where, when, how, and why.**

Subjective: influenced by or based on personal beliefs or feelings

Objective: based on real facts

2

GET THE FACTS

- ✓ Do I know enough to make a decision?
- ✓ What subjective and objective information is available?
- ✓ What are the relevant facts of the case?
- ✓ What facts are not known?
- ✓ Can I learn more about the situation?
- ✓ Do I know enough to make a decision?
- ✓ Have all the relevant persons and groups been consulted?

Some facts may be difficult to find because of the uncertainty often found around ethical issues.

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

ETHICAL DECISION MAKING PROCESS

2

GET THE FACTS

OBJECTIVE INFORMATION:

- ✓ Gargi is aged about 5 and joined the school recently.
- ✓ She is not comfortable with any male members.
- ✓ The teacher noticed the issue
- ✓ Her mother is illiterate.
- ✓ Her mother says Gargi's step-father has chronic health issues.

SUBJECTIVE INFORMATION:

- ✓ Is she a victim of sexual abuse as she is not comfortable with males?
- ✓ Step-father? Is he somehow responsible for Gargi's condition?
- ✓ Why hasn't Gargi's mother taken any measures so far?
- ✓ Is her mother trying to protect her husband?

Questions to ask: **Who, what, where, when, how, and why.**

Subjective: influenced by or based on personal beliefs or feelings

Objective: based on real facts

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

ETHICAL DECISION MAKING PROCESS



3 EVALUATE ALTERNATIVES

THE UTILITARIAN APPROACH

- ✓ Which option will produce the most good and do the least harm?

THE RIGHTS APPROACH

- ✓ Which option best respects the rights of all who have a stake?

THE JUSTICE APPROACH

- ✓ Which option treats people equally or proportionately?

THE COMMON GOOD APPROACH

- ✓ Which option best serves the community as a whole, not just some members?

THE VIRTUE APPROACH

- ✓ Which option leads me to act as the sort of person I want to be?

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

ETHICAL DECISION MAKING PROCESS

4

MAKE A DECISION

- ✓ Which option do you feel addresses the situation best?
- ✓ Which option agrees best with previous decision made?
- ✓ If I told someone knowledgeable or I respect which option I have chosen, what would they say?

The decision we make must be tested before it is implemented.



ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

ETHICAL DECISION MAKING PROCESS

5 REFLECT ON OUTCOME

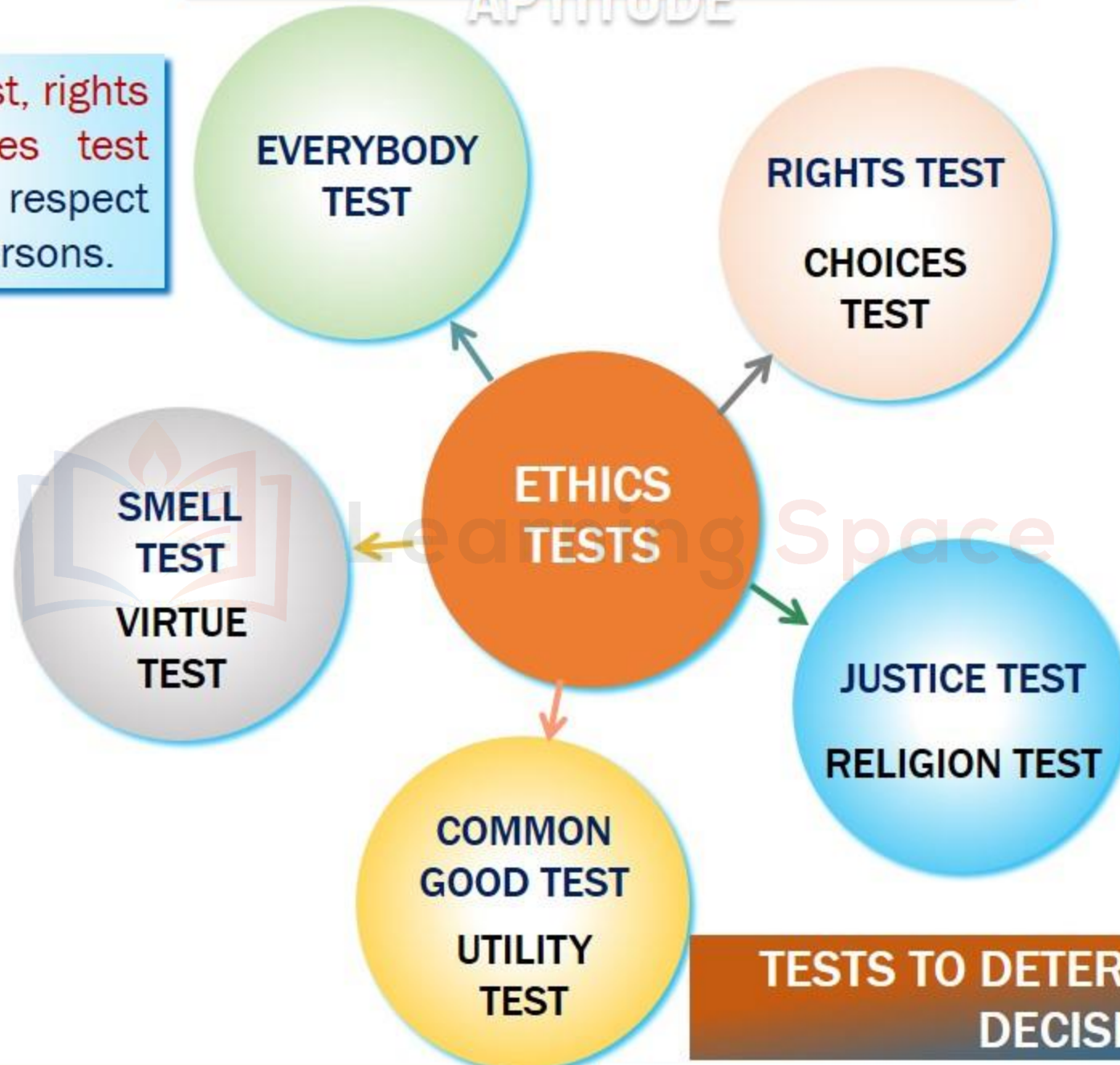


- ✓ How can my decision be implemented with great care and attention to the concerns of all stakeholders?
- ✓ How did my decision turn out?
- ✓ Did it achieve my goals?
- ✓ What have I learned from this specific situation?
- ✓ What are the short term and long term consequences of the decision?

We must take into account our own character and integrity before taking a decision.

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

The **everybody test**, **rights test**, and **choices test** recognise the respect owed to all the persons.



TESTS TO DETERMINE ETHICAL DECISIONS

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

ETHICS TESTS

1 SMELL/VIRAL NEWS TEST

Also called **News Paper Test**, it is widely used in businesses to **preserve a brand's name or personal reputation**.

Considers how would the action or situation we are considering **be viewed by others** if it became viral in the media.



STRENGTH

Recognizes that **morality** is about what **others think** as much as it is about what I think and the test **appeals to 'shame'**.

WEAKNESS

A **society** may be **blind** to the **ethical dimensions** of an action or situation, and may accept unethical actions as ethical, such as **slavery in USA in 17th century**.

It **can not** tell us the reason **why** something is right or wrong.



Would you like to see your proposed action making headline news?

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

ETHICS TESTS

STRENGTH

The emphasis on **rational calculation** and on **including all stakeholders** reminds us that our immediate notions about right and wrong cannot always be trusted.

WEAKNESS

Requires **accurate** probability **assessments of likely outcomes** that may be difficult or impossible to make in complex situations.

In situations where outcomes are measured in short term, it may be **difficult to focus on long term effects**.

2

UTILITY TEST

Based on **utilitarian approach** and believes in **maximum good** and **least harm** as the consequence.

Good outcomes can be **measured by**:

- happiness and unhappiness (pleasure and pain)
- the preferences of individuals
- money, as an indicator of preferences



Are we maximizing good and minimizing harm for everyone affected?

Will this action produce the best outcomes for everyone affected?

3

RIGHTS TEST

Rights recognize **human beings** as valuable in themselves (**intrinsic value**) regardless of their stature, and regardless of what they are worth to others (**extrinsic value**). Animals also have rights, though most people believe that not as many as humans have.



STRENGTH

Human rights have become a very **powerful tool** across the world and we can **draw attention** to an issue by harping on the violation of human rights.

WEAKNESS

Sometimes there is a **disagreement or conflict between two rights**. Exclusive focus on rights may result in **harmful consequences**.



Are we respecting human rights?

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE ETHICS TESTS

STRENGTH

It shows respect for the equality of other humans by respecting their ability to make choices based on what they think is valuable.

WEAKNESS

It assumes that people are clear about what they value and make rational choices based on those values. The concept of freedom is debatable and so is the line between persuasion and coercion.



Are the people affected by this decision able to make their own choices?

4

CHOICES TEST

Focuses on choice of the people to decide what is good for them.

Let others make their own choices based on what they value.

Don't choose for them except in special circumstances: children, for example.



ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE ETHICS TESTS

5

JUSTICE TEST

If everyone has equal value as a human person, then **everyone** has an **equal claim to a share**.

But **if** people are treated **unequally**, there must be a logical and defensible **basis** for such a treatment.



STRENGTH

Fairness is one of the **most fundamental ethical instincts** in humans.

WEAKNESS

As there is **no single criterion** for a fair distribution, the test is always **open to disagreement** among ethical persons.



Is this a fair distribution of benefits and burdens?

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE ETHICS TESTS

STRENGTH

No matter how much a person or group has contributed to their own success, the test reminds them that their success is at least partly due to the society and the environment.

WEAKNESS

Disagreement exists over what constitutes the common good and exactly how to quantify the role of the conditions in the success of a man or group.



Are we doing our part to look out for the common good in this situation?

6 COMMON GOOD TEST

We live in a society and must pay attention not just to our individual benefits but also to the common conditions that are important to the welfare of us all.

Examples of the conditions: social systems and institutions.



ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE ETHICS TESTS

7 EVERYBODY TEST

As **we are all equal** as ethical actors. Whatever is ethical for me must be ethical for others in the same circumstances.



STRENGTH

Reminds us not to give ourselves advantages in regard to what is ethical. We **can't justify being the only one allowed to** or inclined to **do** something.

WEAKNESS

People who are **cruel or extremists** may agree to undertake atrocious actions, which the world will frown upon.



What if everybody did that?

Why should I/we be able to get away with something if others can't?

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE ETHICS TESTS

STRENGTH

Focuses not just on individual actions but **on the larger questions** of what kind of individuals and companies it is good to be and **stresses on the need to acquire virtues.**

WEAKNESS

We do not act in a consistent way across **different situations**: factors in a situation may motivate us more than our character does.



Does this action represent the kind of person/organisation I/we am/are or want to be?

8

VIRTUE TEST

If we know who we are and aspire to be, we can decide how to act by considering whether an action is something that would be done by **the kind of person or organization we want to be.**

- 1) Charity
- 2) Chastity
- 3) Diligence
- 4) Humility
- 5) Kindness
- 6) Patience
- 7) Temperance



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